

7. Polar coordinates

What students need to learn:

Polar coordinates (r, θ) , $r \geq 0$.

The sketching of curves such as

$$\theta = \alpha, r = p \sec(\alpha - \theta), r = a,$$

$$r = 2a \cos \theta, r = k\theta, r = a(1 \pm \cos \theta),$$

$$r = a(3 + 2 \cos \theta), r = a \cos 2\theta \text{ and}$$

$$r^2 = a^2 \cos 2\theta \text{ may be set.}$$

Use of the formula $\frac{1}{2} \int_{\alpha}^{\beta} r^2 d\theta$ for area.

The ability to find tangents parallel to, or at right angles to, the initial line is expected.
